

Personal Ethics

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The course title is *Law, Ethics, and Equity*, and it focuses on helping individuals develop their own standards of conduct. A strong understanding of ethics is essential for distinguishing right from wrong and for comprehending the fundamental nature of morality itself. I believe that individuals have the freedom to choose their course of action.

There are two traditional approaches to the study of normative ethics: deontological and teleological. The deontological approach concerns itself with the rightness or wrongness of specific actions, while the teleological approach focuses on the outcomes of actions in terms of their goodness or badness (Rebore, 2001, p. 15).

I believe that individuals possess an innate understanding of the difference between right and wrong. This understanding is often shaped by our knowledge of the law, personal ethics, and equity. These two theoretical perspectives serve as models for defining what is right, wrong, good, and bad, beginning with our own personal ethics.

Without clear and thorough self-understanding, an individual cannot effectively determine what is right or wrong. For these reasons, I will start my reflection by sharing insights about my own personal ethics and how I plan to enhance them going forward.

What is ethics? I believe that it is a set of moral standards that upholds ethical practice in one's own life, home, workplace, and society. It is a framework that guides people's ethical decision-making, and everyone has a different set of ethical standards. Looking at our textbook (Deskbook, 2006), we have laws covered that just about everyone might find interesting or helpful at one time or another. In addition, our school is subject not only to the law described in the Deskbook (2006) but also to local, state, and federal

laws. In applying the law, a person must understand and conform to the law, to custom, if within the law, and to human values. That is equity. Moreover, a person must have self-discipline when applying ethical standards and the law. A personal standard of conduct dictates how he/she applies the law and decision-making. Beyond right and wrong, our actions also depend on circumstances and are influenced by principles of ethics and fairness.

In conclusion, I believe that a personal standard of conduct serves as a guide for ethical decision-making. Our actions reflect our choices in specific situations, but they do not define our conduct alone. As humans, we are prone to mistakes and may sometimes let our personal preferences inadvertently influence our decisions. Nevertheless, everyone has a responsibility to act ethically and to uphold principles of fairness, reasonableness, and equity. In educational settings, school administrators, teachers, and other leaders play a crucial role in helping individuals understand ethics—to clarify what it is, rather than what it is not. Additionally, it is important to recognize that all ethical considerations are ultimately shaped by the educational leader's perception of what it means to be human and their understanding of how individuals should treat one another (Rebore, 2001 p. 14).